She Kills Monsters

By Qui Nguyen

Suggested Roles: ***Actress 1:*** *Narrator 1, Agnes, Evil Tina, Orcus/Ronnie*
Actress 2: *Narrator 2, Tilly, Chuck, Kaliope, Lilith, Evil Gabbi*

NOTE: This cutting asks each student to portray multiple characters, which is permissible for Nationals and SOME states. It may not meet the rules requirement for DUO in your state! Be sure to check your STATE rules before performing at local tournaments.

NARRATOR 1: **(Pg 7-8)** In a time before Facebook and Worlds of Warcraft, there once existed simply a game -- Forged by the hands of nerds and crafted in the minds of geeks. And here in the land of Ohio during the year of 1995, one of the rarest types of geeks walked the earth -- Tilly Evans.

Lights up on TILLY, a teenage girl decked out in full D&D armor with a sword in hand. She is surrounded by a horde of goblin-like creatures. Suddenly they attack! TILLY slays each of the monsters with grace and efficiency. She stands poised over their dead bodies as the NARRATOR continues. . .

NARRATOR 1: But this story isn't about her. . . This story is about her sister Agnes, the girl who never left home. . . Agnes Evans grew up average. She had average parents and grew up in the average town of Athens, Ohio with her little sister Tilly. Tilly however was anything but average.

TILLY: What are you doing?

AGNES: Talking on the phone. What are you doing?

TILLY: Trying to re-animate a dead lizard with the power of electricity.

AGNES: Oh, okay. . . WHAT!?!

NARRATOR 2: Being a bit more than half a decade apart in age, the two girls had very little in common. Agnes was into more typical things such as boys, music, and popular television programs

NARRATOR 1: While her sister Tilly became fascinated with the dark arts - magic, dragons, and silly costumes . . .

NARRATOR 2: As Agnes grew, she became more engrossed with transcending her averageness and made one grand wish on the night of her college graduation that she would forever regret.

AGNES: I wish my life was less boring.

NARRATOR 2: And so the Gods answered her wish by smiting down her loved ones in a single car crash.

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NARRATOR 1: But this isn't the story of those tragedies. It is a story about how Agnes, the girl who never left home, finally found a way out. . .

INTRODUCTION

ACTRESS 1: *One day as Agnes, a teacher at Tilly's high school, is going through her sister's things, she finds a notebook.*
ACTRESS 2: *A Dungeons and Dragons notebook*
ACTRESS 1: *It becomes her mission to find out more about her sister Tilly by deciphering the contents of that notebook.*
ACTRESS 2: *And thus a quest begins . . . a quest that forges a link between Agnes' reality and Tilly's fantasy.*
TOGETHER: *She Kills Monsters* By Qui Nguyen

Lights come up on CHUCK, a nerdy teen working the counter of a "RPG Gaming Store"

CHUCK: **(Pg 9-11)** *(Singing to himself - Agnes enters and pokes his shoulder which startles him)* WHOA, WHAT THE . . .

AGNES: Sorry, I didn't mean to scare you – I'm looking for a Chuck Biggs?

CHUCK: You're looking at him! So what can I do for you?

AGNES: Rumor has it you know a thing or two about D&D. I have this thing. I'm not quite sure what it is.

CHUCK: Well, lemme checkity check it out! *(AGNES hands CHUCK the notebook)* It's like a map for a D&D game. An adventure. – whoa, wait just a minute. Tillius the Paladin? Was this written by Tilly Evans?

AGNES: You know her?

CHUCK: You kiddin', right? Every player here in Athens has been on a campaign with her. How'd you get ahold of this?

AGNES: She's, um, my sister. So can you help me figure out what it all means? I want to play it. . .

TILLY: **(Pg 13)** *(only Agnes can hear)* You're going to suck at this. You don't even know the difference between a mage or a wizard. You're going to die five seconds into it.

AGNES: Well, you're already dead, so we'll at least have that in common. Chuck. Go. *(the scene changes to one of pure fantasy)*

CHUCK: *(Speaking all-wizard-y on a lower octave)* Greetings, Adventurer! I am Chuck Biggs and I will be your Dungeon Master! **(Pg 15)** Welcome to the Quest for the Lost Soul of Athens. Your mission is find and free the Lost Soul before it is devoured by the dark forces of darkness forever.

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TILLY: (Pg 14-15) Fine! If you're serious about this, then I guess you're going to have to meet the rest of the team.

AGNES: What team?

TILLY: Every adventurer has a party. This one's mine. *(The Actress playing Agnes portrays each member of the party as they are introduced: Suddenly, a leather-clad warrior LILITH appears -- red eyes, vampire fangs, with a very large battle axe)* First up is Lilith Morningstar. Class: Demon Queen. She acts as our squad's muscle -- a perfect combination of both beauty and brawn. *(Next, a very pale, white-haired elf -- tall, lean, and armed with an wooden staff. She looks like a super model)* Next up is Kaliope Darkwalker. Class: Dark Elf. Along with her natural Elvin athleticism and a**-kicking abilities, she's also a master tracker and has a few magical surprises up her sleeves. And then there's me. I'm the brains of this operation. Name: Tilly Evans aka Tillius the Paladin, healer of the wounded and the protector of lights. Class: Awesome! *(both actresses do poses with their weapons as if they're at a photo shoot)*

TILLY: (Pg 16-17) Kaliope, any word on Orcus's location?

AGNES: What's an Orcus?

TILLY: Orcus is a demon overlord of the underworld. If there's a lost soul, he'll either have it or at least know where it is. So, Kaliope, location?

KALIOPE: The entrance to the cave of Orcus is at the next bend.

TILLY: Actually, Agnes, before we can go any further. We're going to have to build you a character. I mean you can't just walk around looking like that. You're going to at least need a shield. . . And your alignment.

AGNES: My what?

LILITH: Are you good, lawful, chaotic, unlawful, evil?

AGNES: I'm a Democrat.

TILLY: No, what will be your character name?

AGNES: Agnes.

TILLY: Stop being an ass-hat, Agnes.

AGNES: No, I want to just use my name. Agnes.

LILITH: Fine, then it is decided, you are Agnes the Ass-hatted. **(Pg 32-33)** *(Lilith kisses Tilly)*

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AGNES: Whoa! Wait just a minute! You two are a couple? *(To Tilly)* Oh, I get it. You two are dating because Tillius is a guy character.

TILLY: No. Tillius is a D&D name. I'm female, she's female.

AGNES: So your character's gay?

TILLY: Does that bother you, Agnes? Wow, I never took you for a homophobe.

AGNES: I'm not a homophobe! I thought I knew you, Tilly. At least good enough to know whether you dug boys or girls at this point in your life.

TILLY: You were busy.

AGNES: Not too busy to know this! Tilly, I'm your sister. I shouldn't have to learn about you through a role-playing game.

TILLY: At least you're getting to learn something about me.

NARRATOR 2: **(Pg 18-19)** And so it was that Agnes the Ass-hatted and Tillius the Paladin ventured forth into the dark dwellings of the truly evil in search for the lost soul of Athens. *(The girls jump out from hiding with weapons drawn.)*

TILLY: It is I, the great Paladin Tillius, healer of the wounded, defender of lights, and I have come here to free a soul. . . Mine.

AGNES: Wait, you're the lost soul of Athens?

Explosive lights and sound as two cheerleaders walk onto stage. They look like normal cheerleaders, except they have sharp teeth, bat wings, and blood all over their mouths. Clearly a scene Tilly experienced at school written into her D&D campaign

EVIL TINA: **(Pg 35-36)** *(to Tilly)* Were you just looking at me?

EVIL GABBI: I think the reason why she was looking at you, Evil Tina, is because she has the hots for you.

TILLY: That's not true.

EVIL TINA: Are you saying I'm ugly?

TILLY: No.

EVIL TINA: Then do you think I'm pretty? Of course you think I'm pretty . . . I knew you were gay!

AGNES: *(AGNES marches up to the two bullies)* **(Pg 37)** And you two going to die! *(Both cheerleaders smile and begin laughing. Their laughter consumes AGNES and TILLY. Their laughter becomes painful and then becomes agony)*

EVIL TINA: We'll see you around. Lesbians. *(They skip away)*

AGNES: Are you okay? **(Pg 41)** Did that sorta stuff really happen? I mean in real life?

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TILLY: I was a dorky fifteen-year old closeted lesbian, what do you think?

AGNES: So how come you had to make a game to tell me all this?

TILLY: I didn't want to tell you all this! This game was supposed to be private.

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(Scene change back to the real world. Agnes is at school, working in her classroom. EVIL TINA and EVIL GABBI enter. Except they aren't evil this time, they're just students. No wings or horns or bloody mouths, just regular cheerleaders. And they're super chipper and nice.)

EVIL TINA: **(Pg 51-52)** Hello, Miss Evans!

EVIL GABBI: Do you have a moment?

EVIL TINA: We're selling Ads for this year's yearbook and we were wondering if you'd be interested in buying an Ad? It could just be a "Congratulations to the Class of 95!" Or a dedication to a loved one who would be graduating this year. . .

EVIL GABBI: *(whispers)* TINA!

EVIL TINA: *(to GABBI)* Shhh. *(to AGNES)* So what do you think?

AGNES: You were in the same class as my sister, right?

EVIL TINA: We were both just devastated when we found out. I mean we didn't hang out after school alot, but –

EVIL GABBI: We'd both consider her a very close friend.

AGNES: Is that right?

EVIL TINA: Not to be too bold, but I think buying a full page AD for Tilly would be. . . just amazing.

AGNES: Can I see your yearbook there? *(Agnes violently throws it)* GET THE HELL OUT OF MY CLASSROOM!!! *(The two girls run out; Agnes calms herself)* Am I going crazy?

TILLY: *(appears from nowhere)* That seemed really effective

AGNES: What am I supposed to do, Tilly? I can't beat up students.

(Pg 57) *Explosion. Evil Tina and Evil Gabbi are back in their evil forms. (TILLY and AGNES fall into defensive stances)*

EVIL GABBI: Oh my God, Evil Tina, look! An impenetrable wall of losers.

EVIL TINA: **(Pg 58)** *(they corner Tilly)* Awww, look at the little nerd girl.

AGNES: Tilly, shoot them with a magic missile.

TILLY: *(cowed)* I can't. I forgot the spell.

EVIL GABBI: Are you going to pee your pants.

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EVIL TINA: Say good-bye, lezzie. **(Pg 59)** You can't hope to beat us.

EVIL GABBI: We're way too powerful for you.

KALIOPE: There's only one way to beat a succubus.

AGNES: [I] challenge you. . . to a dance battle.

CHUCK: BONUS ROUND: AGNES VERSUS THE EVIL SUCCUBUS CHEERLEADER!!!

Music fills the house as AGNES and EVIL GABBI go at it in a full-on cheerleader'esque dance battle. AGNES starts it out. She looks good. . . comedic and funny, but still good. EVIL GABBI is unimpressed by AGNES's skills. She smiles, steps in and starts doing an elaborate Cheerleading/hip-hop fusion routine that completely kills it. Thinking she's won, she raises her arms in victory. When she does, AGNES picks up her weapon and drives it through GABBI while she isn't looking!

AGNES: *(smiles coyly)* What? You really thought we were gonna dance battle you to death. Wow, I guess my sister's right. Cheerleaders are dumb. *(Agnes kills them both then breaks into tears)*

TILLY: **(Pg 61)** Stop. It's just a game.

AGNES: I was getting to know you. I was just starting to get to know you.

TILLY: My character's not dead.

AGNES: But you are. This is a stupid game and you're not real and none of this matters because you died. I'm done. I'm done talking to ghost.

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(Scene changes back to reality. Agnes is at home sorting through Tilly's D&D things)

AGNES:**(Pg 62-63)** *(to audience)* That game was all I had of her. Just a stupid character sheet and whatever she left scribbled out in that notebook. . . My memories are shit. This little nerdy girl who I never talked to, who I ignored, who I didn't understand because she didn't live in the same world as I did. Her world was filled with lesbian demon queens while mine . . . had George Michael and leg-warmers. I didn't even know she didn't like boys. I didn't know her. That breaks my heart. *(a knock at the door)* What are you doing here, Chuck?

CHUCK: I just wanted to show you something. It's something of Tilly's.

AGNES: What? *AGNES gets up and follows CHUCK. A door appears. CHUCK knocks on it.*

CHUCK: **(Pg 64-66)** I just wanted you to meet some of Tilly's friends. Ronnie, this is who I was telling you about. So is your sister around?

ORCUS: Yeah. Lemme get her. You guys can come in if you want, just don't touch the TV, I'm recording Power Rangers! They enter his house.

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NARRATOR 2: Ronnie (ORCUS) returns with his sister Kelly (KALIOPE). She's wheel-chair bound.

KALIOPE: What? Do I have something on my face?

AGNES: Um, no, it's just. . .You play D&D with these guys?

KALIOPE: Yeah, well. It was actually your kid sister that convinced me give it a shot. Your sister was awesome, Miss Evans. We loved her. We really miss her.

AGNES: Me too. (*TILLY enters)*

TILLY: What are you doing?

AGNES: I'm getting to know your friends.

TILLY: I know they're geeky, I'm geeky, we're all geeks.

AGNES: Why do you think I care about that stuff?

TILLY: Everyone else does or did. I mean until I died in a car crash and then suddenly, wow, I'm the most popular girl in school.

AGNES: Is that why all you guys play this?

TILLY: No, we play it because it's awesome. It's about adventures and saving the world and having magic. And maybe, in some capacity, it might have a little to do with wish fulfillment. Kelly gets to walk again and Ronnie gets to be super strong . . . and me? I get the girl.

Lights come up on the "real life" high schooler LILITH. AGNES approaches.

AGNES: **(Pg 66-67)** Can we talk for a minute? Look, I know you're not gay or . . . You were at her funeral.

LILITH: I mean, she wasn't my girlfriend, but I always knew she was, you know, interested. Tilly was my first kiss. I'm pretty sure I was hers too. I thought you'd might want to know that about your sister. And Miss Evans - I loved her. *(Lilith exits)*

TILLY: **(Pg 70-71)** Good job.

AGNES: Tilly? *(sadly resigned)* You're not real. You're gone.

TILLY: But this story remains. And isn't that all that life is - a collection of stories? This is one of mine. . . *(TILLY speaks the next lines, assuming the character voices that she created) AS KALIOPE:* . . . and not just some story that I experienced like a party or a dance, but something I dreamt – *AS LILITH:* Something far more personal and important than happenstance. This story came from my soul and by breathing life into it, who knows? *AS ORCUS:* Maybe a bit of my soul gets the chance to breathe for a moment once again. *AS CHUCK:* I love you, my sister. *AS TILLY:* I'm sorry I can't be there. *AS CHUCK:* I have no idea why you had to experience this adventure alone without

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me. But I hope it gave you a glimpse into me the way I wanted you to see me – *AS ORCUS:* Strong... *AS LILITH:* Powerful... *AS KALIOPE:* And magical. *AS CHUCK:* Congratulations, you have finished the Quest for the Lost Soul of Athens.

NARRATOR 2: And so...Agnes the Ass-hatted accomplished her very first quest.

NARRATOR 1: Tilly was never forgotten, and eventually the world finally embraced nerds not as outsiders, but as awesome.

NARRATOR 2: Agnes moved out of that old house and brought the many memories of an average life with her.

NARRATOR 1: And this made her happy.

SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

2014 National Qualifier
2015 National Qualifier
2016 National Qualifier
2016 National Qualifier – MS
2017 National Qualifier
2019 National Qualifier
2020 National Qualifier
2021 National Qualifier
2022 National Qualifier – MS
2023 National Qualifier
2023 National Qualifier - MS
2024 National Qualifier
NIETOC
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